የድንጋይ ሾርባ

Stone Soup

Review revision: PILOT-FAMILY-R1-2026-07-05-STONE-SOUP

Audience: ages 3-6

Origin basis: European/international ATU 1548 tradition

Story pages: 12

For adult family/cultural review

Read naturally with a child in one sitting. This reviews the story, not the child. Mark the page when wording changes aloud, attention drops, a transition feels rushed, or a moment creates confusion, fear, delight, prediction, or a request to continue.

Do not record a child's name, exact age, contact details, school, location, photo, audio, video, medical information, or other identifying details. Use the assigned anonymous session code and broad age band only.

This copy is not text locked. Illustration beats are planning notes, not final artwork.

Story page 1

Amharic

አንድ መንገደኛ ረጅም መንገድ ተጉዞ በምሽት ወደ ትንሽ መንደር ደረሰ። በጣም ደክሞት እና ተርቦም ነበር።

English

After a long journey, a traveller reached a small village in the evening. He was very tired and hungry.

Illustration beat

Tired traveller approaching a quiet village at sunset.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 2

Amharic

በመንደሩ እየዞረ የብዙ ሰዎችን በር አንኳኳ። “የምታካፍሉኝ ትንሽ ምግብ አላችሁ?” ብሎ ጠየቀ። ሰዎቹ ግን “ያለን ለቤተሰባችን ብቻ የሚበቃ ነው” አሉት።

English

He walked around the village and knocked on many doors. “Do you have a little food to share with me?” he asked. “What we have is only enough for our families,” the villagers replied.

Illustration beat

Several villagers answering cautiously but not harshly.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 3

Amharic

ተጓዡም አላዘነም። በመንደሩ መካከል ያለውን የውሃ ጉድጓድ አይቶ “እንግዲያው የድንጋይ ሾርባ እሠራለሁ” አለ።

English

The traveller did not become discouraged. He noticed the village well. “Then I shall make stone soup,” he said.

Illustration beat

Traveller smiling thoughtfully beside the well.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 4

Amharic

ንጹሕ ድንጋይ አጥቦ በትልቅ ማሰሮ ውስጥ አስቀመጠ። ውሃ ጨመረበትና ትንሽ እሳት አቀጣጠለ።

English

He washed a clean stone and placed it in a large pot. He added water and lit a small cooking fire.

Illustration beat

Clean stone dropping into pot over safe cooking fire.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 5

Amharic

የአካባቢው ልጆች በጉጉት ወደ ተጓዙ ቀረቡ። “ድንጋይ እንዴት ሾርባ ይሆናል?” አሉ። ተጓዡም “ከእናንተ ትንሽ እርዳታ ጋር ጣፋጭ ይሆናል” ብሎ ፈገግ አለ።

English

The local children approached the traveller curiously. “How can a stone become soup?” they asked. “With a little help from you, it can become delicious,” the traveller said with a smile.

Illustration beat

Curious children peering safely into pot.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 6

Amharic

አንዲት ልጅ “እኔ ሁለት ካሮት ማምጣት እችላለሁ” አለች። እናቷን ጠይቃ ካሮቶቹን አመጣች፣ ሁሉም አብረው ወደ ማሰሮው ጨመሯቸው።

English

“I can bring two carrots,” said one child. She asked her mother, brought the carrots, and everyone added them to the pot together.

Illustration beat

Child and parent contributing carrots with consent.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 7

Amharic

አንድ ጎረቤት ትንሽ ድንች፣ ሌላው ደግሞ በቆሎ አመጣ። አንዲት አያትም “ከጓሮዬ ትንሽ ቅጠል አለኝ” ብለው ጨመሩ።

English

One neighbour brought a potato, and another brought some maize. A grandmother added, “I have a few herbs from my garden.”

Illustration beat

Different generations bringing small ingredients.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 8

Amharic

ማሰሮው “ፍልቅልቅ፣ ፍልቅልቅ” እያለ መቀቀል ጀመረ። ጣፋጭ ሽታው በመንደሩ ሲሰራጭ ተዘግተው የነበሩ በሮች ተከፈቱ።

English

Bubble, bubble went the pot. As its delicious smell drifted through the village, doors that had been closed began to open.

Illustration beat

Steam curling through village as doors open.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 9

Amharic

አንዳንዶቹ ውኃ ቀዱ፣ አንዳንዶቹ ሳህን አዘጋጁ፣ ሌሎቹም ጠረጴዛ ዘረጉ። ትንሽ ትንሽ እየሠሩ ትልቅ እራት አዘጋጁ።

English

Some fetched water, some set out bowls, and others prepared a long table. Many small acts were turning into one big supper.

Illustration beat

Villagers sharing different preparation jobs.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 10

Amharic

ተጓዡ ሾርባውን ቀምሶ “አንድ ነገር ቀርቶታል” አለ። ሁሉም በጉጉት ተመለከቱት። “አብረን መቀመጥ!” ብሎ ሳቀ።

English

The traveller tasted the soup. “One thing is still missing,” he said. Everyone leaned closer. “We must sit down together!” he laughed.

Illustration beat

Traveller's playful reveal; villagers laughing with relief.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 11

Amharic

ሁሉም በጠረጴዛው ዙሪያ ተቀምጠው ሞቅ ያለውን ሾርባ ተካፈሉ። “ይህን ሁሉ ያዘጋጀው ድንጋዩ ነው?” ብሎ አንድ ልጅ ጠየቀ።

English

Everyone sat around the table and shared the warm soup. “Did the stone make all of this?” one child asked.

Illustration beat

Warm communal table; child pointing curiously toward pot.

Adult notes for this page

Story page 12

Amharic

“ድንጋዩ የጀመረው ጨዋታውን ብቻ ነው፤ ሾርባውን ያዘጋጀው የእያንዳንዳችሁ ትንሽ ስጦታ ነው” አለ ተጓዡ። ከዚያ ቀን በኋላ የመንደሩ ነዋሪዎች ትንሽ ነገር ሲካፈሉት ለሁሉም እንደሚበቃ ተገነዘቡ።

English

“The stone only started the game,” said the traveller. “The soup came from each small gift you shared.” From then on, the villagers understood that when they shared even a little, there could be enough for everyone.

Illustration beat

Stone resting beside empty bowls as community smiles together.

Adult notes for this page

Session scorecard

Anonymous session code: _____ Broad age band: 3-4 / 5-6

Language: Amharic / English Adult role: parent / caregiver / educator / other

Completed story: Yes / No

Rate 1 (serious problem) to 5 (ready), or mark N/A.

Measure	1-5	Page/evidence
Language sounded natural aloud		
Sentences were easy to read		
Child followed the story flow		
Page pacing felt unhurried		
Conflict felt emotionally safe		
Ending felt clear and satisfying		
Child remained interested		
Illustration beats support understanding		

Observations and recommendation

Words changed aloud; confusing or rushed pages; child questions; delight or prediction; fear or discomfort; remembered part; suggested revision:

Recommendation: Pass / Revise wording / Revise page flow / Reconsider age band / Cultural review / Safety review / Replace

Return this adult scorecard through the owner's private route. Remove identifying child details before submission.